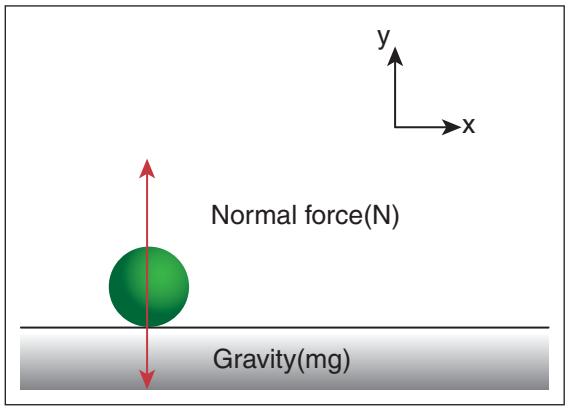
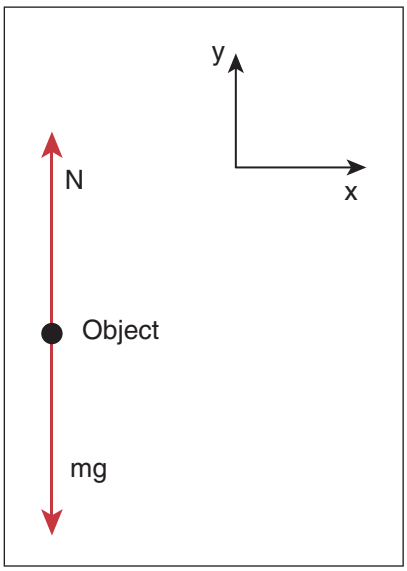
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i) Gravity acting downward (negative y-direction)
ii) Normal force by the surface of the Earth acting upward (positive y-direction)

The free body diagram for this object is



$$\vec{F}_g = -mg\hat{j}$$
$$\vec{N} = N\hat{j}$$

Net force $\vec{F}_{net} = -mg\hat{j} + N\hat{j}$

But there is no acceleration on the ball. So $\vec{a} = 0$. By applying Newton's second law ($\vec{F}_{net} = m\vec{a}$)

Since $\vec{a} = 0, \vec{F}_{net} = -mg\hat{j} + N\hat{j}$

$$(-mg + N)\hat{j} = 0$$

By comparing the components on both sides of the equation, we get

$$-mg + N = 0$$
$$N = mg$$

We can conclude that if the object is at rest, the magnitude of normal force is exactly equal to the magnitude of gravity.

EXAMPLE 3.10

A particle of mass 2 kg experiences two forces, $\vec{F}_1 = 5\hat{i} + 8\hat{j} + 7\hat{k}$ and $\vec{F}_2 = 3\hat{i} - 4\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$. What is the acceleration of the particle?

Solution

We use Newton's second law, $\vec{F}_{net} = m\vec{a}$ where $\vec{F}_{net} = \vec{F}_1 + \vec{F}_2$. From the above equations the acceleration is $\vec{a} = \frac{\vec{F}_{net}}{m}$, where

$$\vec{F}_{net} = (5+3)\hat{i} + (8-4)\hat{j} + (7+3)\hat{k}$$
$$\vec{F}_{net} = 8\hat{i} + 4\hat{j} + 10\hat{k}$$
$$\vec{a} = \left(\frac{8}{2}\right)\hat{i} + \left(\frac{4}{2}\right)\hat{j} + \left(\frac{10}{2}\right)\hat{k}$$
$$\vec{a} = 4\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 5\hat{k}$$

EXAMPLE 3.11

Identify the forces acting on blocks A, B and C shown in the figure.

Solution

